

Full Italian Curriculum: A1 → B2

Curriculum Philosophy

This curriculum follows one integrated path:

A1 → A2 → B1 → B2

Each level includes:

1. **Communicative Functions** — what you can do in real life
2. **Grammar & Structures** — how Italian works
3. **Vocabulary Domains** — topic-based word groups
4. **Listening Skills**
5. **Speaking Skills**
6. **Reading Skills**
7. **Writing Skills**
8. **Cultural Competence**
9. **Academic / Certification Skills**
10. **Exit Outcomes**

This reflects the CEFR action-oriented model, which describes language learning in terms of practical language use across personal, public, educational, and professional domains. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int)

A1 — Beginner / Breakthrough Level

A1 Goal

At A1, your goal is to handle **very simple communication**: introduce yourself, ask basic questions, understand slow speech, read signs/menus, and write short personal messages. This aligns with CEFR A1 descriptors for understanding familiar words, basic phrases, simple notices, and simple interaction when the other person helps. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu)

A1 Curriculum Map

Unit A1.1 — Sounds, Alphabet, and First Contact

Communicative goals

- Greet people formally and informally
- Say goodbye
- Say please, thank you, sorry
- Ask “How are you?”
- Introduce your name

Grammar

- Italian alphabet
- Vowels and consonants
- Double consonants: *pala* vs *palla*
- Stress and syllables
- Basic sentence order
- Subject pronouns: *io, tu, lui, lei, noi, voi, loro*

Vocabulary

- Greetings
- Polite expressions
- Countries and nationalities
- Basic classroom phrases

Listening

- Recognize greetings
- Identify names and countries
- Understand very slow introductions

Speaking

- Introduce yourself in 3–5 sentences
- Spell your name
- Ask someone’s name and nationality

Reading

- Read basic signs and classroom instructions

Writing

- Write a short self-introduction

Cultural competence

- Formal vs informal greetings: *ciao* vs *buongiorno*
 - Basic use of *tu* and *Lei*
-

Unit A1.2 — Identity and Personal Information

Communicative goals

- Say your age
- Say where you are from
- Say what languages you speak
- Ask basic personal questions

Grammar

- Verb *essere*
- Verb *avere*
- Present tense of *chiamarsi*
- Gender of nouns
- Singular and plural nouns
- Definite articles: *il, lo, la, l', i, gli, le*
- Indefinite articles: *un, uno, una, un'*

Vocabulary

- Age
- Numbers 0–100
- Nationalities
- Languages
- Professions

Listening

- Understand simple personal introductions

Speaking

- Conduct a short introduction exchange

Reading

- Understand a short personal profile

Writing

- Complete a personal information form

Academic / certification skill

- Understand exam-style identity questions
-

Unit A1.3 — Family and Description

Communicative goals

- Talk about family
- Describe people simply
- Say possession

Grammar

- Possessive adjectives: *mio, tuo, suo*
- Adjective agreement
- Common adjectives
- Verb *avere* for physical description
- Verb *essere* for personality

Vocabulary

- Family members
- Physical appearance
- Personality
- Basic emotions

Listening

- Understand simple family descriptions

Speaking

- Describe your family

- Describe a person in a photo

Reading

- Read simple family descriptions

Writing

- Write 5–8 sentences about your family

Cultural competence

- Italian family vocabulary and forms of address
-

Unit A1.4 — Daily Objects, House, and Location

Communicative goals

- Say where things are
- Describe your room or home
- Ask where something is

Grammar

- *C'è / ci sono*
- Simple prepositions: *a, in, di, da, con, su, per*
- Prepositional phrases of place
- Demonstratives: *questo, quello*
- There is / there are

Vocabulary

- House rooms
- Furniture
- Objects
- Places in town

Listening

- Understand simple location descriptions

Speaking

- Describe your room
- Ask where an object is

Reading

- Read a simple apartment description

Writing

- Describe your home
-

Unit A1.5 — Food, Café, and Restaurant

Communicative goals

- Order food and drinks
- Ask for prices
- Ask for the bill
- Express likes and dislikes

Grammar

- Present tense regular verbs: *-are*
- Verb *piacere* introduction
- Articles with food nouns
- Basic negation: *non*
- Questions with *quanto, cosa, dove*

Vocabulary

- Food
- Drinks
- Café items
- Restaurant phrases
- Prices

Listening

- Understand café orders
- Recognize prices

Speaking

- Order at a café
- Ask for the bill
- Say what you like

Reading

- Read a menu

Writing

- Write a short food preference paragraph

Cultural competence

- Italian café culture
 - Breakfast and meal habits
-

Unit A1.6 — Daily Routine

Communicative goals

- Talk about your daily routine
- Say times
- Talk about frequency

Grammar

- Present tense regular verbs: *-ere, -ire*
- Reflexive verbs introduction: *alzarsi, lavarsi, vestirsi*
- Time expressions
- Frequency adverbs: *sempre, spesso, qualche volta, mai*

Vocabulary

- Daily activities
- Time
- Days of the week
- Parts of the day

Listening

- Understand a simple daily schedule

Speaking

- Describe your typical day

Reading

- Read a simple daily routine text

Writing

- Write your daily routine
-

Unit A1.7 — City, Directions, and Transport

Communicative goals

- Ask for directions
- Understand simple directions
- Buy a ticket
- Ask where a place is

Grammar

- Imperative introduction: *scusi, vada, gira*
- Modal verbs: *potere, volere, dovere*
- Prepositions with places
- Verb *andare*
- Verb *venire*

Vocabulary

- City places
- Transportation
- Directions
- Tickets
- Public services

Listening

- Understand basic directions

Speaking

- Ask for directions
- Say where you need to go

Reading

- Read signs and simple maps

Writing

- Write directions from one place to another
-

Unit A1.8 — Shopping and Clothing

Communicative goals

- Ask for sizes
- Ask for prices
- Say what you want
- Express basic preferences

Grammar

- Verb *volere*
- Verb *preferire*
- Direct object pronouns introduction: *lo, la, li, le*
- Colors and adjective agreement
- Comparatives introduction: *più... di*

Vocabulary

- Clothes
- Colors
- Sizes
- Shops
- Payment

Listening

- Understand shop exchanges

Speaking

- Buy an item in a shop

Reading

- Read price tags and short advertisements

Writing

- Write a short shopping dialogue
-

Unit A1.9 — Free Time and Hobbies

Communicative goals

- Talk about hobbies
- Make simple plans
- Say what you do in your free time

Grammar

- Present tense irregular verbs: *fare, uscire, stare*
- Verb *giocare*
- Verb *suonare*
- Prepositions with activities
- Basic connectors: *e, ma, anche, perché*

Vocabulary

- Hobbies
- Sports
- Music
- Entertainment
- Weekend activities

Listening

- Understand someone talking about free time

Speaking

- Talk about hobbies and weekends

Reading

- Read a short event listing

Writing

- Write about your weekend
-

Unit A1.10 — Review and A1 Survival Project

Integrated project

Create a basic personal survival portfolio:

- self-introduction
- family description
- daily routine
- restaurant dialogue
- city directions dialogue
- shopping dialogue

A1 exit outcomes

By the end of A1, you should be able to:

- introduce yourself
- ask and answer simple questions
- order food
- ask for directions
- describe family and routine
- understand slow, clear speech
- write short simple texts

These outcomes align with CEFR A1 self-assessment descriptors. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu)

A2 — Elementary / Waystage Level

A2 Goal

At A2, your goal is to handle **routine daily situations independently**: travel, shopping, appointments, health, housing, work basics, and simple past events. CEFR A2 includes understanding high-frequency vocabulary, simple messages, short texts, and routine exchanges. [coe.int], [europass.europa.eu]

A2 Curriculum Map

Unit A2.1 — Past Experiences: Passato Prossimo

Communicative goals

- Talk about what you did yesterday
- Talk about past trips
- Ask others about past events

Grammar

- *Passato prossimo*
- Auxiliary verbs *essere* and *avere*
- Past participles
- Agreement with *essere*
- Common irregular past participles

Vocabulary

- Yesterday / last week / last year
- Travel experiences
- Weekend activities
- Events

Listening

- Understand simple past narratives

Speaking

- Tell what you did last weekend

Reading

- Read a simple travel blog entry

Writing

- Write a short past-event paragraph
-

Unit A2.2 — Travel and Accommodation

Communicative goals

- Book accommodation
- Check in at a hotel
- Explain travel problems
- Ask for travel information

Grammar

- Prepositions with cities, countries, and transport
- *Dove, quando, quanto, quale*
- Modal verbs in past tense
- Review of *andare, venire, partire, arrivare*

Vocabulary

- Hotels
- Airports
- Train stations
- Tickets
- Travel problems

Listening

- Understand hotel and station dialogues

Speaking

- Role-play hotel check-in
- Ask about train times

Reading

- Read timetables and travel notices

Writing

- Write a hotel booking message
-

Unit A2.3 — Health and Emergencies

Communicative goals

- Say what hurts
- Describe symptoms
- Ask for medicine
- Make a doctor appointment

Grammar

- Indirect object pronouns introduction: *mi, ti, gli, le, ci, vi*
- Verb *fare male*
- Reflexive verbs review
- Imperative polite forms introduction

Vocabulary

- Body parts
- Symptoms
- Pharmacy
- Medicine
- Emergency phrases

Listening

- Understand simple doctor/pharmacy dialogues

Speaking

- Explain symptoms

Reading

- Read simple medicine instructions

Writing

- Write a message to cancel or request an appointment

Unit A2.4 — Home, Renting, and Services

Communicative goals

- Describe housing needs
- Talk to a landlord
- Report a problem
- Understand rental ads

Grammar

- *C'è / ci sono* review
- Partitive articles: *del, della, dei*
- Prepositions with rooms and furniture
- Comparatives: *più... di, meno... di, come*

Vocabulary

- Housing
- Utilities
- Repairs
- Furniture
- Rental advertisements

Listening

- Understand apartment descriptions

Speaking

- Describe your ideal apartment

Reading

- Read rental listings

Writing

- Write a message about a housing problem
-

Unit A2.5 — Work, Study, and Daily Responsibilities

Communicative goals

- Talk about work/study routines
- Describe responsibilities
- Talk about skills
- Make simple professional introductions

Grammar

- Present tense review
- *Sapere vs conoscere*
- *Dovere, potere, volere* in routine contexts
- Adverbs of frequency and manner

Vocabulary

- Jobs
- Office
- Study subjects
- Skills
- Work tasks

Listening

- Understand simple work/study descriptions

Speaking

- Describe your job or study

Reading

- Read a simple job ad

Writing

- Write a short professional profile

Unit A2.6 — Imperfetto and Describing the Past

Communicative goals

- Describe childhood
- Talk about past habits
- Describe how things were

Grammar

- *Imperfetto*
- *Passato prossimo* vs *imperfetto* introduction
- Time markers: *quando ero piccolo, una volta, sempre*
- Descriptive past language

Vocabulary

- Childhood
- School life
- Memories
- Past habits

Listening

- Understand someone describing childhood

Speaking

- Talk about your childhood

Reading

- Read a simple memoir-style text

Writing

- Write about your childhood or past routine

Unit A2.7 — Invitations, Plans, and Social Life

Communicative goals

- Invite someone
- Accept and refuse invitations

- Make plans
- Suggest activities

Grammar

- Future tense introduction
- *Stare per + infinitive*
- *Vorrei* for polite requests
- Pronouns review

Vocabulary

- Social plans
- Events
- Invitations
- Time arrangements
- Celebrations

Listening

- Understand phone calls and invitations

Speaking

- Make plans with someone

Reading

- Read event announcements

Writing

- Write an invitation message

Unit A2.8 — Food Culture and Cooking

Communicative goals

- Understand recipes
- Explain simple cooking steps
- Talk about food habits

Grammar

- Imperative informal forms
- Quantity expressions
- Partitives review
- Direct object pronouns with food

Vocabulary

- Ingredients
- Cooking verbs
- Kitchen tools
- Italian dishes

Listening

- Understand a simple recipe video

Speaking

- Explain how to cook a simple dish

Reading

- Read a recipe

Writing

- Write your own simple recipe
-

Unit A2.9 — Opinions and Preferences

Communicative goals

- Express likes and dislikes more clearly
- Give simple reasons
- Compare options
- Say what you prefer

Grammar

- *Piacere* expanded

- Indirect pronouns with *piacere*
- Comparatives and superlatives
- Connectors: *perché, quindi, però, invece*

Vocabulary

- Movies
- Music
- Books
- Hobbies
- Opinions

Listening

- Understand short opinions

Speaking

- Talk about a movie, song, or book

Reading

- Read short reviews

Writing

- Write a simple review

Unit A2.10 — A2 Integration Project

Integrated project

Prepare a self-study portfolio:

- travel story
- hotel booking message
- health dialogue
- apartment description
- childhood paragraph
- invitation dialogue
- simple review

A2 exit outcomes

By the end of A2, you should be able to:

- handle routine travel and daily-life interactions
- talk about past experiences
- describe habits and memories
- make plans
- understand short simple texts
- write short personal and practical messages

These outcomes align with CEFR A2 descriptors for routine exchanges, short texts, and high-frequency personal/social vocabulary. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu)

B1 — Intermediate / Threshold Level

B1 Goal

At B1, your goal is to become an **independent user**. You should handle most situations while traveling, understand clear speech on familiar topics, describe experiences, express opinions, and produce connected text. CEFR B1 explicitly includes understanding main points on familiar matters and dealing with most travel situations. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu)

B1 Curriculum Map

Unit B1.1 — Narrating Clearly

Communicative goals

- Tell a story
- Sequence events
- Explain what happened
- React to someone's story

Grammar

- *Passato prossimo* review

- *Imperfetto* review
- Contrast: background vs completed event
- Time connectors: *prima, poi, dopo, mentre, alla fine*

Vocabulary

- Life events
- Accidents
- Travel stories
- Reactions

Listening

- Understand personal stories

Speaking

- Tell a 2–3 minute story

Reading

- Read narrative texts

Writing

- Write a structured narrative

Unit B1.2 — Opinions and Discussion

Communicative goals

- Express opinions
- Agree and disagree
- Give reasons
- Ask for someone's view

Grammar

- Opinion structures:
 - *secondo me*
 - *penso che*
 - *credo che*

- Present subjunctive introduction after opinion verbs
- Connectors: *però, tuttavia, infatti, quindi*

Vocabulary

- Opinions
- Society
- Lifestyle
- Education
- Work

Listening

- Understand slow discussions on familiar topics

Speaking

- Participate in short discussions

Reading

- Read simple opinion articles

Writing

- Write an opinion paragraph
-

Unit B1.3 — Future, Plans, and Hypothetical Intentions

Communicative goals

- Talk about future plans
- Make predictions
- Express hopes
- Discuss goals

Grammar

- Future tense
- Future of irregular verbs
- *Spero di / spero che*
- Introduction to subjunctive with hope

Vocabulary

- Career plans
- Study plans
- Life goals
- Technology and future

Listening

- Understand future plans

Speaking

- Discuss your future

Reading

- Read articles about future trends

Writing

- Write about your future goals
-

Unit B1.4 — Advice, Obligation, and Problem Solving

Communicative goals

- Give advice
- Ask for advice
- Discuss problems
- Explain consequences

Grammar

- Conditional present: *vorrei, dovrei, potrei*
- *Bisogna / è necessario / è meglio*
- Imperative review
- Pronouns with infinitives

Vocabulary

- Problems

- Advice
- Personal decisions
- Everyday conflicts

Listening

- Understand advice conversations

Speaking

- Give advice in common situations

Reading

- Read advice columns

Writing

- Write a response giving advice
-

Unit B1.5 — Work and Professional Life

Communicative goals

- Describe work experience
- Talk about skills
- Handle job-related situations
- Prepare for simple interviews

Grammar

- Past tense review in professional contexts
- Relative pronouns: *che*, *cui*
- Formal register introduction
- Direct and indirect pronoun review

Vocabulary

- CV
- Job interviews
- Workplace
- Skills

- Professional communication

Listening

- Understand job interview questions

Speaking

- Present your work/study background

Reading

- Read job ads and simple CVs

Writing

- Write a simple CV profile and cover message
-

Unit B1.6 — Media, News, and Current Events

Communicative goals

- Understand simple news
- Summarize a short article
- Discuss current events
- Express concern or interest

Grammar

- Passive voice introduction
- Impersonal *si*
- Connectors for cause/effect
- Reported information introduction

Vocabulary

- News
- Society
- Environment
- Technology
- Public life

Listening

- Understand simplified news

Speaking

- Summarize a news item

Reading

- Read short news articles

Writing

- Write a short news summary
-

Unit B1.7 — Travel Problems and Formal Requests

Communicative goals

- Make complaints
- Ask for refunds
- Explain problems formally
- Negotiate simple solutions

Grammar

- Formal imperative
- Conditional for politeness
- Object pronouns in formal contexts
- *Vorrei, mi potrebbe, sarebbe possibile*

Vocabulary

- Complaints
- Customer service
- Travel issues
- Bureaucracy

Listening

- Understand service interactions

Speaking

- Make a polite complaint

Reading

- Read customer-service emails

Writing

- Write a formal complaint email
-

Unit B1.8 — Culture, Traditions, and Regional Italy

Communicative goals

- Talk about traditions
- Compare cultures
- Explain customs
- Discuss regional differences

Grammar

- Comparatives and superlatives review
- *Mentre, invece, rispetto a*
- Relative clauses review
- Past habitual narration

Vocabulary

- Traditions
- Festivals
- Food culture
- Regions
- Cultural identity

Listening

- Understand cultural explanations

Speaking

- Compare your culture with Italian culture

Reading

- Read cultural articles

Writing

- Write a cultural comparison
-

Unit B1.9 — Education and Learning

Communicative goals

- Talk about your learning experience
- Discuss school/university
- Describe learning difficulties
- Explain preferences

Grammar

- Subjunctive after necessity and opinion
- *È importante che...*
- *Penso che...*
- *Preferisco che...*

Vocabulary

- Education
- Exams
- Learning methods
- University
- Academic subjects

Listening

- Understand study-related conversations

Speaking

- Discuss learning strategies

Reading

- Read educational texts

Writing

- Write about your learning journey
-

Unit B1.10 — Relationships and Social Interaction

Communicative goals

- Talk about friendships
- Describe relationships
- Resolve misunderstandings
- Express emotions

Grammar

- Reflexive and reciprocal verbs
- Pronouns review
- *Mi sembra che*
- Emotional expressions with subjunctive introduction

Vocabulary

- Relationships
- Emotions
- Personality
- Social situations

Listening

- Understand conversations about relationships

Speaking

- Discuss social situations and emotions

Reading

- Read personal letters/messages

Writing

- Write a personal message explaining feelings
-

Unit B1.11 — Certification Skills: B1 Foundation

Exam skill goals

Certification exams such as CILS, CELI, and PLIDA test listening, reading, writing, and speaking, with CILS also including language-structure analysis. [cla.unipv.it], [europassitalian.com], [societadan...ghieri.org]

Listening

- Identify main idea
- Extract details
- Understand speakers' intentions

Reading

- Understand short articles
- Identify opinions
- Match information

Writing

- Informal email
- Formal email
- Short opinion text

Speaking

- Personal interview
 - Describe experiences
 - Express opinions
-

Unit B1.12 — B1 Integration Project

Integrated project

Create a B1 portfolio:

- personal narrative
- opinion essay
- formal complaint email
- job profile
- news summary
- cultural comparison
- oral presentation on a familiar topic

B1 exit outcomes

By the end of B1, you should be able to:

- handle most daily situations independently
- understand clear standard speech
- discuss familiar topics
- narrate past experiences
- express opinions with reasons
- write connected texts
- begin serious certification preparation

These outcomes align with CEFR B1 descriptors for familiar matters, travel situations, connected speech, and writing about experiences and opinions. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu)

B2 — Upper Intermediate / Vantage Level

B2 Goal

At B2, your goal is to use Italian as a **working academic and professional language**. You should understand complex texts, follow extended speech, discuss abstract topics, interact with fluency, and write structured arguments. CEFR B2 includes understanding extended speech, following complex argumentation on familiar topics, understanding news/current affairs, and reading articles where writers express viewpoints. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu)

B2 is also a common threshold for Italian-taught university admission or exemption from language testing. [\[unifi.it\]](https://unifi.it), [\[unipg.it\]](https://unipg.it)

B2 Curriculum Map

Unit B2.1 — Advanced Tense Control

Communicative goals

- Narrate complex events
- Explain causes and consequences
- Shift between past, present, and future accurately

Grammar

- *Passato prossimo*
- *Imperfetto*
- *Trapassato prossimo*
- Future tense
- Conditional
- Sequence of tenses introduction

Vocabulary

- Life events
- Social change
- Personal development
- Cause/effect language

Listening

- Understand extended personal narratives

Speaking

- Tell a complex life or work story

Reading

- Read long-form narrative articles

Writing

- Write a structured narrative with reflection

Unit B2.2 — Full Subjunctive System I

Communicative goals

- Express opinions with nuance
- Express doubt
- Express emotion
- Express necessity

Grammar

- Present subjunctive review
- Past subjunctive
- Subjunctive after:
 - opinion
 - doubt
 - emotion
 - necessity
- Indicative vs subjunctive contrast

Vocabulary

- Abstract opinions
- Feelings
- Judgement
- Social issues

Listening

- Recognize subjunctive in spoken opinions

Speaking

- Give nuanced opinions

Reading

- Read opinion articles

Writing

- Write an argumentative paragraph using subjunctive structures

Unit B2.3 — Full Subjunctive System II

Communicative goals

- Discuss hypothetical situations
- Express conditions
- Talk about unreal or uncertain events

Grammar

- Imperfect subjunctive
- Pluperfect subjunctive
- Conditional past
- Hypothetical clauses:
 - reality
 - possibility
 - unreality

Vocabulary

- Hypothetical situations
- Regret
- Possibility
- Decision-making

Listening

- Understand speculative discussions

Speaking

- Discuss “what would happen if...”

Reading

- Read essays with hypothetical reasoning

Writing

- Write a conditional argument
-

Unit B2.4 — Argumentation and Debate

Communicative goals

- Build arguments
- Defend a position
- Challenge ideas politely
- Give evidence and examples

Grammar

- Argument connectors:
 - *inoltre*
 - *tuttavia*
 - *nonostante*
 - *sebbene*
 - *poiché*
 - *di conseguenza*
- Concessive clauses
- Causal clauses
- Contrast clauses

Vocabulary

- Debate language
- Agreement/disagreement
- Evidence
- Public issues

Listening

- Understand debates and interviews

Speaking

- Debate a familiar abstract topic

Reading

- Read editorials

Writing

- Write a structured argumentative essay
-

Unit B2.5 — Formal and Academic Writing

Communicative goals

- Write formal emails
- Write summaries
- Write reports
- Structure essays clearly

Grammar

- Formal register
- Nominalization introduction
- Passive voice
- Impersonal constructions
- Formal connectors

Vocabulary

- Academic verbs:
 - analyze
 - demonstrate
 - argue
 - suggest
 - evaluate
- Report language
- Formal email phrases

Listening

- Understand formal announcements and short lectures

Speaking

- Present a structured argument

Reading

- Read academic-style texts

Writing

- Write:
 - formal email
 - summary
 - report
 - opinion essay
-

Unit B2.6 — Media, Politics, and Society

Communicative goals

- Discuss public issues
- Understand viewpoints in media
- Compare political/social perspectives
- Summarize arguments

Grammar

- Reported speech
- Passive and impersonal forms
- Advanced relative clauses
- Subordinate clauses

Vocabulary

- Government
- Society
- Rights
- Economy basics
- Media
- Public policy

Listening

- Understand news and current-affairs programs

Speaking

- Discuss a social issue

Reading

- Read news analysis and opinion pieces

Writing

- Write a media summary and response
-

Unit B2.7 — Work, Professional Communication, and Presentations

Communicative goals

- Participate in meetings
- Present a project
- Express professional opinions
- Negotiate and clarify

Grammar

- Formal conditional
- Passive voice review
- Discourse markers
- Relative pronouns:
 - *il quale*
 - *la quale*
 - *i quali*
 - *le quali*

Vocabulary

- Workplace communication
- Projects
- Meetings
- Negotiation
- Problem-solving

Listening

- Understand professional discussions

Speaking

- Give a 5–7 minute presentation

Reading

- Read professional reports

Writing

- Write a professional proposal or meeting summary
-

Unit B2.8 — University and Academic Life

Communicative goals

- Discuss academic subjects
- Understand course descriptions
- Communicate with professors
- Explain research interests

Grammar

- Academic syntax
- Complex noun phrases
- Passive/impersonal academic style
- Advanced connectors

Vocabulary

- University
- Research
- Exams
- Lectures
- Academic administration
- Fields of study

Listening

- Understand short lectures

Speaking

- Explain an academic interest

Reading

- Read university pages and academic abstracts

Writing

- Write a formal email to a professor
 - Write an academic summary
-

Unit B2.9 — Literature, Cinema, and Culture

Communicative goals

- Discuss films and books
- Interpret themes
- Express aesthetic opinions
- Connect culture with history

Grammar

- Descriptive and interpretive language
- Relative clauses review
- Subjunctive in evaluation
- Past tenses in literary/cultural discussion

Vocabulary

- Cinema
- Literature
- Art
- History
- Interpretation
- Cultural criticism

Listening

- Understand film reviews and interviews

Speaking

- Discuss a film or book

Reading

- Read short literary excerpts or reviews

Writing

- Write a cultural review

This cultural component reflects university Italian programs that integrate language with literature, cinema, history, and contemporary Italian culture. [\[dlcl.stanford.edu\]](https://dlcl.stanford.edu/), [\[elts.ucla.edu\]](https://elts.ucla.edu/)

Unit B2.10 — Advanced Listening and Spoken Interaction

Communicative goals

- Follow fast conversations
- Interrupt politely
- Ask for clarification
- Reformulate ideas
- Manage misunderstandings

Grammar

- Discourse markers:
 - *cioè*
 - *insomma*
 - *allora*
 - *comunque*
 - *in realtà*
- Pragmatic expressions
- Register shifts

Vocabulary

- Conversational fillers
- Idiomatic expressions
- Clarification language
- Nuance and tone

Listening

- Understand podcasts, interviews, and native conversations

Speaking

- Participate in spontaneous conversation

Reading

- Read informal forum or comment-style texts

Writing

- Write a reflective response to spoken content
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Unit B2.11 — Certification Preparation: B2

Exam skill goals

B2-level certification preparation should include all major skill areas tested by recognized exams: listening, reading, writing, speaking, and, depending on the exam, grammar/language-structure analysis. CILS exams include listening, reading, analysis of communication structures, written production, and oral production, while PLIDA emphasizes listening, reading, writing, and speaking. [\[cla.unipv.it\]](http://cla.unipv.it), [\[europassitalian.com\]](http://europassitalian.com), [\[societadan...ghieri.org\]](http://societadan...ghieri.org)

Listening

- Understand interviews
- Understand lectures
- Understand news
- Identify viewpoint and implication

Reading

- Understand long articles
- Identify argument structure
- Infer meaning from context
- Recognize author attitude

Writing

- Formal email
- Essay

- Report
- Summary
- Argumentative response

Speaking

- Monologue
- Discussion
- Opinion defense
- Image/text-based commentary
- Formal interaction

Grammar

- Subjunctive
- Hypothetical clauses
- Pronouns
- Passive
- Reported speech
- Connectors
- Register

Unit B2.12 — B2 Capstone Project

Integrated project

Create a B2-level academic and communication portfolio:

1. **Formal email**
Example: request information from a university office.
2. **Argumentative essay**
Example: advantages and disadvantages of remote work.
3. **News summary**
Example: summarize and respond to an Italian news article.
4. **Oral presentation**
Example: 7-minute presentation on an Italian cultural/social topic.
5. **Debate task**
Example: defend a position on technology, education, environment, or migration.
6. **Listening journal**
Example: summarize 10 podcast/news episodes.

7. Reading portfolio

Example: summarize 10 articles and identify author viewpoints.

B2 exit outcomes

By the end of B2, you should be able to:

- interact with native speakers with fluency and spontaneity
- understand extended speech and lectures on familiar topics
- understand news and current-affairs content
- read articles and reports with viewpoints
- write clear, detailed texts
- argue for and against positions
- function in many academic and professional contexts
- prepare seriously for B2 certification

These outcomes align with CEFR B2 descriptors and the B2 certification/university-admission role of Italian language exams. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu), [\[unifi.it\]](https://unifi.it), [\[unipg.it\]](https://unipg.it)

Skill Progression Summary

Listening Progression

A1: slow phrases, greetings, prices, directions

A2: routine conversations, announcements, travel/hotel/health situations

B1: clear speech on familiar topics, simple news, stories

B2: lectures, interviews, news, complex arguments on familiar topics

This progression follows CEFR listening development from recognizing basic phrases at A1 to understanding extended speech and lectures at B2. [\[coe.int\]](https://coe.int), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](https://europass.europa.eu)

Speaking Progression

A1: simple questions and answers

A2: routine exchanges

B1: connected speech, opinions, experiences

B2: spontaneous interaction, debate, presentation

This reflects CEFR progression from simple interaction at A1 to fluent and spontaneous interaction at B2. [\[coe.int\]](#), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](#)

Reading Progression

A1: signs, menus, simple messages

A2: advertisements, timetables, short letters

B1: everyday/job-related texts and personal descriptions

B2: articles, reports, viewpoints, contemporary prose

This is aligned with CEFR reading descriptors from A1 to B2. [\[coe.int\]](#), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](#)

Writing Progression

A1: forms, short messages, simple descriptions

A2: personal emails, short narratives, practical messages

B1: connected texts, opinions, formal/informal emails

B2: essays, reports, summaries, formal academic writing

This follows CEFR writing development and certification-style written production expectations.
[\[coe.int\]](#), [\[europass.europa.eu\]](#), [\[cla.unipv.it\]](#)

Grammar Progression Summary

A1 Grammar Core

- pronunciation
- articles
- noun gender and number
- present tense
- *essere / avere*
- basic irregular verbs
- adjectives
- simple prepositions
- modal verbs

- basic questions
- negation

A2 Grammar Core

- *passato prossimo*
- *imperfetto*
- reflexive verbs
- direct and indirect pronouns
- comparatives
- future tense
- imperative
- partitives
- *piacere*
- routine connectors

B1 Grammar Core

- past tense contrast
- future
- conditional present
- present subjunctive introduction
- relative pronouns
- passive introduction
- impersonal *si*
- formal register
- connectors
- object pronoun combinations

B2 Grammar Core

- full subjunctive system
- hypothetical clauses
- conditional past
- passive voice
- reported speech
- advanced connectors
- formal/academic register
- relative clauses
- sequence of tenses
- idiomatic and pragmatic structures

Academic / Certification Progression

A1

Focus:

- accurate spelling
- basic listening comprehension
- basic forms
- short responses

A2

Focus:

- practical messages
- short emails
- simple narratives
- routine listening tasks

B1

Focus:

- personal opinion writing
- formal/informal emails
- short oral monologues
- basic exam simulation

B2

Focus:

- essays
- summaries
- reports
- presentations
- debate

- exam-format listening and reading
- grammar accuracy under time pressure

This matches the structure of recognized Italian certification systems, where exams assess listening, reading, writing, speaking, and sometimes grammar/language structures. [\[cla.unipv.it\]](http://cla.unipv.it), [\[europassitalian.com\]](http://europassitalian.com), [\[societadan...ghieri.org\]](http://societadan...ghieri.org)

Recommended Self-Study Output Portfolio

To make this curriculum practical, you should produce a portfolio at each level.

A1 Portfolio

- self-introduction
- family description
- daily routine
- restaurant dialogue
- city directions dialogue
- shopping dialogue

A2 Portfolio

- travel story
- hotel booking email
- health/pharmacy dialogue
- apartment description
- childhood memory
- invitation message
- simple review

B1 Portfolio

- personal narrative
- opinion paragraph
- formal complaint email
- job profile

- news summary
- cultural comparison
- short oral presentation

B2 Portfolio

- argumentative essay
 - formal academic email
 - report
 - news analysis
 - oral presentation
 - debate recording
 - listening journal
 - reading summary portfolio
-

References

CEFR / European Framework

1. **Council of Europe — CEFR Self-Assessment Grid**
Used for A1–B2 skill descriptors in listening, reading, spoken interaction, spoken production, and writing. [coe.int]
 2. **Europass — Common European Framework of Reference for Language Skills**
Used for practical “can-do” descriptors across A1–B2. [europass.europa.eu]
 3. **Council of Europe — CEFR learning, teaching, assessment framework**
Used for the action-oriented curriculum model and the division into reception, production, interaction, mediation, and domains of use. [coe.int]
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University Italian Programs

4. **University of Bologna — Italian language courses for international learners**
Used as a reference for CEFR-based progression and academic/everyday Italian integration. [corsi.unibo.it]
5. **University of Siena — Italian language courses for international students**
Used as a reference for A1, A2, B1, B2 course-level organization. [unisi.it]

6. **Stanford Italian Language Program**
Used as a reference for combining language study with culture, literature, cinema, and Italian historical-cultural context. [\[dlcl.stanford.edu\]](http://dlcl.stanford.edu)
7. **UCLA Italian Program**
Used as a reference for university-level Italian progression from elementary/intermediate language into culture, literature, film, and academic study. [\[elts.ucla.edu\]](http://elts.ucla.edu)

Certification / Academic Requirement References

8. **CILS — Università per Stranieri di Siena / CILS structure references**
Used for exam skill areas: listening, reading, language structures, writing, speaking. [\[cla.unipv.it\]](http://cla.unipv.it), [\[europassitalian.com\]](http://europassitalian.com)
9. **CELI — Università per Stranieri di Perugia / CVCL**
Used as reference for official Italian certification and CEFR-aligned exam levels. [\[CVCL: Cent...stiche ...\]](#)
10. **PLIDA — Società Dante Alighieri**
Used as reference for CEFR-aligned Italian certification and four-skill testing. [\[plida.dante.global\]](http://plida.dante.global), [\[societadan...ghieri.org\]](http://societadan...ghieri.org)
11. **University of Florence — Italian language knowledge requirement**
Used as reference for B2-level Italian certification as an academic admission/exemption threshold. [\[unifi.it\]](http://unifi.it)
12. **University of Perugia — Language requirements**
Used as reference for B2-level CLIQ-recognized Italian certifications for Italian-taught programs. [\[unipg.it\]](http://unipg.it)

Type	Name	Description: Used for Which Activities in the Curriculum	Source
Core textbook	Nuovissimo Progetto Italiano 1 — A1/A2	Main textbook spine for A1 and A2 : pronunciation, basic grammar, dialogues, vocabulary, listening, culture, writing prompts, and communicative tasks. It includes student book, exercise book, audio/video, interactive resources, and cultural materials. [youtube.com] , [Learn Ital...exercises]	[Edilingua official page] [youtube.com]
Core textbook	Nuovissimo Progetto	Main textbook spine for B1 and B2 : intermediate grammar, longer dialogues, social/cultural topics,	[Edilingua official page] [youtube.com]

	Italiano 2 — B1/B2	argumentation, reading, listening, speaking, and writing development. Officially mapped to B1–B2 . [youtube.com]	
Grammar workbook	Italian Grammar in Practice — A1/B2	Main grammar-support book for the whole course. Used for grammar explanations, controlled exercises, review tests, and self-correction from A1 to B2 . Especially useful for articles, verbs, pronouns, prepositions, past tenses, future, conditional, relative pronouns, imperative, and subjunctive. [italicus.com.pl] , [amazon.com] , [pinterest.com]	[Alma Edizioni official page] [italicus.com.pl]
Optional grammar workbook	Practice Makes Perfect: Complete Italian Grammar	Optional extra grammar practice for English speakers. Useful when you need more explanation in English, especially for verb tenses, pronouns, adjectives, prepositions, and grammar drills. [raicultura.it] , [languagelearning.site]	[McGraw Hill official page] [raicultura.it]
Alternative textbook series	Nuovo Espresso 1–4 / Nuovo Espresso Plus	Alternative textbook spine if you prefer one book per CEFR level: A1, A2, B1, B2 . Good for communicative classroom-style learning, video grammar, dialogues, and contemporary Italian input. [italicus.com.pl] , [europass.europa.eu] , [britishcouncil.mk]	[Alma Edizioni / textbook listing] [italicus.com.pl] , [britishcouncil.mk]
Website	LearnAmo	Flexible grammar, vocabulary, culture, and review support. Use for A1/A2 grammar basics, B1/B2 intermediate grammar, vocabulary expansion, written explanations, videos, and automatic exercises. [ubt-uni.net]	[LearnAmo lessons] [ubt-uni.net]
Website	Online Italian Club	Free CEFR-based exercise bank. Use for extra grammar exercises, listening, vocabulary, dialogues, verbs, reading, level tests, and review from A1 to B2 . [unisi.it]	[Online Italian Club] [unisi.it]

Website / worksheets	Loescher Italiano per Stranieri	Free downloadable worksheets organized by CEFR level and skill. Use for grammar, phonetics, listening, reading, writing, speaking, vocabulary, communicative functions, culture, and certification practice. [elts.ucla.edu] , [europassitalian.com]	[Loescher Italiano per Stranieri] [elts.ucla.edu]
Website / video lessons	RAI Scuola — Corso d’Italiano per stranieri	Official Italian learning video resource. Use for listening practice, basic-to-intermediate vocabulary, cultural/civic topics, and A1–B2 video input. [colanguage.com]	[RAI Scuola course] [colanguage.com]
Website / extra resources	Mondadori Education — Italian for Foreigners	Extra free resources by level and skill. Use for grammar, lexis, phonetics, audio, speaking/comprehension, writing/comprehension, activities, and culture videos from A1 to B2. [bruinplan.com]	[Mondadori Education resources] [bruinplan.com]
YouTube / listening	Easy Italian	Main real-life listening resource. Use for pronunciation, natural speech, street interviews, beginner “Super Easy Italian,” everyday vocabulary, cultural exposure, and listening with Italian/English subtitles. [cils.unistrasi.it] , [iicstoccar....esteri.it]	[Easy Italian YouTube] [cils.unistrasi.it]
YouTube / grammar	LearnAmo YouTube	Main video grammar support. Use for explanations of beginner grammar, restaurant dialogue, prepositions, pronouns, subjunctive, verb moods/tenses, intermediate grammar tests, and cultural vocabulary. [standardiz...dtests.org] , [CVCL: Cent...stiche ...] , [europassitalia.com] , [europassitalian.com]	[LearnAmo YouTube] [standardiz...dtests.org]
YouTube / textbook- aligned video	Edilingua YouTube	Video support connected to Edilingua textbook ecosystem. Use alongside Nuovissimo Progetto Italiano / Edilingua materials for listening, pronunciation, cultural videos, and course-style video input. [youtube.com] , [youtube.com]	[Edilingua YouTube] [youtube.com]
YouTube / video supplement	Via del Corso videos	Optional story-based video supplement from Edilingua. Use for A1–B2 listening, dialogue shadowing,	[Via del Corso playlist] [easyitalian.fm]

		cultural clips, and more engaging story-based input. [easy-languages.org] , [easyitalian.fm]	
Podcast / listening	Easy Italian Podcast	B1–B2 listening immersion. Use for real conversations, listening journals, summarizing episodes, vocabulary extraction, and training for longer spoken Italian. [unitrebarga.it] , [iicstoccar....esteri.it]	[Easy Italian Podcast] [unitrebarga.it]
Certification material	CILS — Università per Stranieri di Siena	Use from B1 onward , serious preparation at B2 . Useful for exam-style listening, reading, grammar/communication structures, written production, and oral production. [italiano-bello.com] , [buscalibre.es]	[CILS information] [italiano-bello.com]
Certification material	CELI — Università per Stranieri di Perugia / CVCL	Use as an alternative or additional certification path. Useful for CEFR-aligned Italian exam preparation and academic certificate planning. [italiano-bello.com]	[CVCL / CELI official site] [italiano-bello.com]
Certification material	PLIDA — Società Dante Alighieri	Use for four-skill exam preparation: listening, reading, writing, and speaking. Useful from B1 onward and especially for B2 certification practice. [casadellelingue.eu] , [edilingua.it]	[PLIDA official page] [casadellelingue.eu]